TRAIL

Don't just get there.
Discover along the way.

TASK 1

Problem Statement

Problem → Users → Current Behavior → Pain Points → Core Problem → Opportunity → Problem Statement

01 — THE PROBLEM

Discovery is built around destinations, not journeys

People can easily find places through search engines, maps, social media, blogs and recommendations.

But finding individual destinations is not the same as deciding how those places become a meaningful journey.

THE GAP

Finding a place is easy.

Connecting places into a worthwhile journey requires additional planning.

THE CURRENT EXPERIENCE

Search → Find places → Compare → Save → Manually plan → Navigate

THE TRAIL QUESTION

Instead of “Where should I go?”

TRAIL asks: “What can I discover along the way?”

02 — WHO EXPERIENCES THIS?

Target users

PRIMARY · CURIOUS YOUNG EXPLORERS

Students and young adults who:

- Have limited time to explore
- Enjoy discovering new places
- May not have a fixed destination
- Want less-obvious places
- Don’t want to spend significant time planning
- Explore independently or with friends

SECONDARY · LOCAL EXPLORERS & CREATORS

People who:

- Know interesting local places
- Enjoy creating routes
- Want to share experiences
- Can contribute local knowledge and curated trails

EXPLORATION CONTEXT

The problem becomes relevant when someone has **limited time**, wants to **explore**, has **no fixed destination** and wants something **beyond the obvious**.

03 — HOW PEOPLE EXPLORE TODAY

The current solution

People use several platforms to discover individual places.

01 **SEARCH**

Google Maps · Search

Find places by location, category and popularity.

02 **DISCOVER**

Instagram · YouTube · Reddit · Blogs

Find recommendations, photos, experiences and ideas.

03 **COMPARE**

Reviews · Images · Popularity · Distance · Opening info

Judge personal relevance.

04 **ASSEMBLE**

Which places? What order? How much time? What to skip?

The user decides manually.

EXISTING TOOLS HELP USERS FIND PLACES.

THE USER STILL HAS TO BUILD THE JOURNEY.

04 — THE FRICTION

Where the experience breaks down

Seven initial pain-point hypotheses:

01 DESTINATION-CENTRIC
Focus is on individual places rather than how places connect.

02 POPULARITY-DRIVEN
Popular places can dominate, making less-obvious ones harder to surface.

03 FRAGMENTED
Discovery is spread across multiple platforms.

04 MANUAL JOURNEY PLANNING
Users decide which places belong together and in what order.

05 TIME CONSTRAINTS
Hard to know what realistically fits into an outing.

06 MISSED DISCOVERIES
Interesting places may be overlooked if outside the original destination.

07 LIMITED SPONTANEITY
Heavy planning reduces the chance of unexpected discovery.

FOOTNOTE

These are initial hypotheses to validate through user research, not established findings.

05 — THE CORE PROBLEM

Finding places is not the same as building a journey

TODAY A PERSON MAY FIND

Café · Bookstore · Street Art · Bakery · Viewpoint

BUT THEY STILL HAVE TO ASK

- Which ones should I visit?
- In what order?
- How long will the journey take?
- Which places fit my interests?
- Which discoveries are worth a detour?

THE CORE PROBLEM

Discovery tools make it easier to locate individual places, but connecting them into a meaningful journey can still require significant manual effort.

THE SHIFT

Individual destinations



Connected discovery

06 — THE OPPORTUNITY

From destination to journey

TRAIL explores an opportunity to make discovery more journey-oriented.

USER INPUTS

- **Location** — Where am I exploring?
- **Interests** — What am I curious about?
- **Time** — How much time do I have?
- **Distance** — How far do I want to explore?

TRAIL · CONNECT

Places based on relevance, distance, sequence and context.

Outcome: a possible discovery journey

CORE HYPOTHESIS

Users need an easier way to discover and combine interesting places into a journey based on their interests, available time and preferred distance.

INTERESTS + TIME + LOCATION + DISTANCE



DISCOVERY 01 → 02 → 03 → 04

07 — THE PROBLEM STATEMENT

The opportunity in one statement

PROBLEM

People can easily discover individual destinations across maps, search engines and social platforms, but turning those discoveries into a coherent, worthwhile journey requires fragmented research and manual planning.

USER

Curious young explorers with limited time who want to discover interesting or less-obvious places without spending significant effort planning.

NEED

A simpler way to connect relevant places into a journey based on interests, available time, location and preferred distance.

OPPORTUNITY

Shift discovery from “Where should I go?” to “What can I discover along the way?”

